TE REO MĀORI · ANY LEVEL

Relief lessons Pukapuka mahi · Workbook

Ingoa / Name:

Akomanga / Class:

Kaiako / Teacher:

Tau / Year:

6 lessons · Waiheke High School

Ngā ihirangi · Contents

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Matariki: the Māori New Year

We are learning about Matariki, the Māori New Year, and the stars of the Matariki cluster.

No te reo Māori needed. Time: **60 minutes**. Students know their level: Ara 1 = Novice 1, Ara 2 = Novice 2, Ara 3 = Novice 3. If a student is not sure, they start with Ara 1 and move on when they finish.

1. **Start:** (5 min) Greet the class (Kia ora koutou). Karakia if usual. Show slides 1–3 and read the Matariki introduction together.
2. **Learn:** (10 min) Slides 4–5: the nine stars and the three Matariki themes. Students say the star names after a confident student, or read them together.
3. **Do:** (35 min) Worksheet: everyone does Parts A–C, then their Ara section, then the drawing. Early finishers choose from the list at the bottom of the sheet.
4. **Finish:** (10 min) Pairs share their Matariki wish and their hākari menu. Two or three share with the class. Collect sheets. Ka kite anō!

Say it · pronunciation help

Kia ora koutou (kee-ah AW-rah koh-toh-oo): Hello everyone
Ka pai (kah pie): Good, well done
Ka kite anō (kah KEE-teh ah-NAW): See you again

Print and devices

Print the worksheet for each student. Coloured pencils for the drawing task. Not needed. Early finishers with devices can play Te Kete Ngaro or Te Reo Wero (links on this page).

Answers

- Part A: Pōhutukawa = those who have died; Tupuānuku = food grown in the ground; Waitā = the ocean and its food; Ururangi = the winds; Waipunarangi = rain; Hiwa-i-te-rangi = wishes for the year ahead.
- Part B: before dawn in June or July (mid-winter); the Māori New Year; any of: remembering people, sharing kai, making wishes or plans.
- Part C: answers vary (e.g. kūmara or rīwai; birds or fruit; tuna (eel) or watercress; ika or kai moana).
- Ara 1: star; food; water; wind; rain; sky; wish.
- Ara 2 and 3: answers vary. Check “Ko taku wawata, kia …”, “Ka kai mātou i te …”, “Ka maumahara au ki …” and macrons.

At the end: collect the worksheets and leave them for the class teacher with a note of who was here.

Ingoa / Name:	Akomanga / Class:	Rā / Date:

Matariki: te tau hou Māori

Relief lesson · all levels. Do Parts A–C, then your Ara section, then the drawing.

Pānui · Read. Matariki is a cluster of stars that rises in the early morning sky in June or July. Its rising marks **te tau hou Māori** (the Māori New Year). There are nine stars, and each is linked to part of the world: kai from the land, sea and sky, water, rain, wind, the people we remember, and our wishes for the year ahead. Matariki has been a public holiday since 2022.

Part A · Match each whetū (star) to what it is connected to.

Pōhutukawa	• •	the winds
Tupuānuku	• •	wishes for the year ahead
Waitā	• •	those who have died
Ururangi	• •	rain
Waipunarangi	• •	food grown in the ground
Hiwa-i-te-rangi	• •	the ocean and its food

Part B · Answer in English.

1. When does Matariki rise? _____
2. What does Matariki mark? _____
3. Name one way people celebrate Matariki. _____

Part C · Plan a Matariki hākari (feast). Choose one kai for each star and write it in te reo or English.

Whetū (star)	Where the kai comes from	My kai
Tupuānuku	the ground	
Tupuārangi	trees and birds	
Waitī	fresh water	
Waitā	the ocean	

Ara 1 · Write the English.

1. whetū _____
2. kai _____
3. wai _____
4. hau _____
5. ua _____
6. rangi _____
7. wawata _____

Ara 2 · Sentence starters

- *Ko taku wawata, kia … (My wish is that …)*
- *Ko taku wawata, kia kaha au ki te kōrero Māori.*
- *Ka kai mātou i te … (We will eat …)*

Ara 2 · Write two Matariki wishes in te reo, then one sentence about the kai you will share.

Ara 3 · Write 4–5 sentences in te reo about your Matariki: who you will remember (Ka maumahara au ki …), what kai you will share, and your wish for the year (Ko taku wawata, kia …). Add one reason with nā te mea.

Everyone: draw the Matariki cluster and label three stars.

Finished early? *Write a Matariki wish for our class or school · Make a word search with 8 Matariki kupu for a partner · Draw a Matariki poster for your whānau*

Place-name detectives

We are learning to break Māori place names into parts to work out what they mean.

No te reo Māori needed. Time: **60 minutes**. Students know their level: Ara 1 = Novice 1, Ara 2 = Novice 2, Ara 3 = Novice 3. If a student is not sure, they start with Ara 1 and move on when they finish.

1. **Start:** (5 min) Greet the class. Show slide 3: ask who knows what Rotorua or Aotearoa means.
2. **Learn:** (10 min) Slides 4–5: go through the word parts and decode two names together (Rotorua, Waiwera).
3. **Do:** (35 min) Worksheet: everyone does Parts A and B, then their Ara section, then the island design. Early finishers choose from the list at the bottom of the sheet (or use the Place Names Map if devices are allowed).
4. **Finish:** (10 min) Pairs swap and decode each other's island names. Share the best ones. Collect sheets.

Say it · pronunciation help

Kia ora koutou (kee-ah AW-rah koh-toh-oo): Hello everyone
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Print and devices

Print the worksheet. Optional: devices for the Place Names Map. Optional: the Te Reo Māori Place Names Map for early finishers (link on this page).

Answers

- Part A: Waiwera = wai + wera, hot water; Rotoiti = roto + iti, small lake; Whanganui = whanga + nui, big harbour; Maunganui = maunga + nui, big mountain; Motutapu = motu + tapu, sacred island; Puketapu = puke + tapu, sacred hill; Oneroa = one + roa, long beach.
- Part B: North (Te Ika-a-Māui): Rotorua, Taupō, Whanganui. South (Te Waipounamu): Kaikōura, Ōtautahi, Aoraki.
- Ara 1: wai; roto; maunga; motu; nui; iti; wera.
- Ara 2 and 3: answers vary. Check Kei + place + a + name, and "nā te mea he …".

At the end: collect the worksheets and leave them for the class teacher with a note of who was here.

Ingoa / Name:	Akomanga / Class:	Rā / Date:

Place-name detectives

Relief lesson · all levels. Use the word parts to decode the names.

Kupu / Word bank: wai = water · roto = lake · maunga = mountain · motu = island · awa = river · nui = big · iti = small · roa = long · tapu = sacred · wera = hot · one = sand, beach · puke = hill · whanga = harbour, bay

Part A · Decode the place names.

Place name	Parts	Meaning
Waiwera		
Rotoiti		
Whanganui		
Maunganui		
Motutapu		
Puketapu		
Oneroa		

Part B · Which island? Tick Te Ika-a-Māui (North) or Te Waipounamu (South).

Place	Te Ika-a-Māui	Te Waipounamu
Rotorua		
Kaikōura		
Taupō		
Ōtautahi		
Whanganui		
Aoraki		

Ara 1 · Write the te reo word.

1. water _____
2. lake _____
3. mountain _____
4. island _____
5. big _____
6. small _____
7. hot _____

Ara 2 · Sentence starters

- *Kei Te Ika-a-Māui a Rotorua. (Rotorua is in the North Island.)*
- *Kei Te Waipounamu a Kaikōura. (Kaikōura is in the South Island.)*
- *He roto nui a Taupō. (Taupō is a big lake.)*

Ara 2 · Write three sentences in te reo about places in Aotearoa, using the starters.

Ara 3 · Invent a te reo name for a place at school (the field, library, canteen …) using the word parts. Explain it in te reo: Ko … te ingoa, nā te mea he …

Everyone: design an imaginary island. Draw it and give six places te reo names made from the word parts (e.g. Rotoroa = long lake).

Finished early? *Write the English meaning beside each of your island names · Find three more Māori place names you know and try to decode them · Write a sentence about your island: He motu ātaahua a …*

Kupu puzzle challenge

We are learning to recognise and spell te reo Māori words through puzzles.

No te reo Māori needed. Time: **60 minutes**. Students know their level: Ara 1 = Novice 1, Ara 2 = Novice 2, Ara 3 = Novice 3. If a student is not sure, they start with Ara 1 and move on when they finish.

1. **Start:** (5 min) Greet the class. Slide 3: read the Māori alphabet together, in order.
2. **Learn:** (5 min) Slide 4: crack the first code word together (5-4-1 = kia).
3. **Do:** (40 min) Worksheet: everyone does Parts A–D, then their Ara section, then makes their own puzzle (Part E). Students can work in pairs.
4. **Finish:** (10 min) Pairs swap their Part E puzzles and solve them. Check answers together using the answer key. Ka pai!

Say it · pronunciation help

Kia ora koutou (kee-ah AW-rah koh-toh-oo): Hello everyone
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Ka kite anō (kah KEE-teh ah-NAW): See you again

Print and devices

Print the worksheet. Pairs are fine. Not needed. Early finishers with devices can play Te Reo Wero (link on this page).

Answers

- Part A: ka pai; mōrena; whānau; ka kite anō.
- Part B: Kai: āporo, parāoa, ika · Tae: whero, pango, kahurangi · Whānau: māmā, pāpā, tuakana · Huarere: ua, hau, paki.
- Part C: Hānuere (a month, not a day); kurī (a dog, not a colour); tēpu (a table, not family); rangi (sky, not a number).
- Part D: aroha, kai, pango, tama, ngeru, whero.
- Ara 1: whero; pango; kōwhai.
- Ara 2: Rāhoroi; Hānuere; tuakana.
- Ara 3: Kei te pai ahau. · Ko Aroha taku ingoa. · I haere au ki Rotorua inanahi. · He pai ki ahau te tiakarete.

At the end: collect the worksheets and leave them for the class teacher with a note of who was here.

Ingoa / Name:	Akomanga / Class:	Rā / Date:

Kupu puzzle challenge

Relief lesson · all levels. Use the code: a1 e2 h3 i4 k5 m6 n7 o8 p9 r10 t11 u12 w13 ng14 wh15.

Part A · Crack the code (add macrons where needed).

1. 5-1 / 9-1-4 _____
2. 6-8-10-2-7-1 _____
3. 15-1-7-1-12 _____
4. 5-1 / 5-4-11-2 / 1-7-8 _____

Part B · Sort the words: āporo, whero, māmā, ua, parāoa, pango, pāpā, hau, ika, kahurangi, tuakana, paki

Kai (food)	Tae (colours)	Whānau (family)	Huarere (weather)

Part C · Odd one out. Circle it and say why.

1. Rāhina · Rātū · Hānuere · Rāapa _____
2. whero · kōwhai · kurī · pango _____
3. māmā · pāpā · tuakana · tēpu _____
4. tahi · rua · toru · rangi _____

Part D · Put these words in Māori alphabet order (remember ng and wh come last).

1. whero · aroha · ngeru · kai · pango · tama _____

Ara 1 · Unscramble the colours.

1. r o w h e _____ (red)
2. g n a o p _____ (black)
3. i w h k o a _____ (yellow, add the macron)

Ara 2 · Crack the code.

1. 10-1-3-8-10-8-4 _____ (a day)
2. 3-1-7-12-2-10-2 _____ (a month)
3. 11-12-1-5-1-7-1 _____ (whānau)

Ara 3 · Unjumble the sentences.

1. ahau / Kei / pai / te _____
2. ingoa / Ko / taku / Aroha _____
3. ki / I / Rotorua / haere / au / inanahi _____

4. he / ki / pai / te / ahau / tiakarete _____

Part E · Everyone: make your own puzzle for a partner: three code words (or sentences for Ara 3) and a scrambled word. Write the answers on the back.

Finished early? *Write your name and three friends' names in the code · Make a crossword with 6 te reo words and English clues · Write a secret message to the class in the code*

Whakataukī: wisdom for today

We are learning what some well-known whakataukī mean and how they can guide us today.

No te reo Māori needed. Time: **60 minutes**. Students know their level: Ara 1 = Novice 1, Ara 2 = Novice 2, Ara 3 = Novice 3. If a student is not sure, they start with Ara 1 and move on when they finish.

1. **Start:** (5 min) Greet the class. Slide 3: read the first whakataukī together and ask what students think it means.
2. **Learn:** (10 min) Slides 4–5: read each whakataukī and its meaning; students repeat the te reo.
3. **Do:** (35 min) Worksheet: everyone does Parts A–C, then their Ara section, then the poster. Early finishers choose from the list at the bottom of the sheet.
4. **Finish:** (10 min) Class vote: which whakataukī should be our class motto? A few students share their poster and reasons. Collect sheets.

Say it · pronunciation help

Kia ora koutou (kee-ah AW-rah koh-toh-oo): Hello everyone
Ka pai (kah pie): Good, well done
Ka kite anō (kah KEE-teh ah-NAW): See you again

Print and devices

Print the worksheet. Coloured pencils or felts for the poster. Not needed.

Answers

- Part A: rourou = when we all contribute, the people thrive; He aha te mea nui = the most important thing is people; Mā te huruhuru = support people so they can succeed; Ehara taku toa = my strength is not that of one person, but of many.
- Part B: Ehara taku toa … (or Nāku te rourou …); Mā te huruhuru …; Whāia te iti kahurangi ….
- Ara 1: bird; person; people or tribe; mountain.
- Ara 2 and 3: answers vary.

At the end: collect the worksheets and leave them for the class teacher with a note of who was here.

Ingoa / Name:	Akomanga / Class:	Rā / Date:

Whakataukī: wisdom for today

Relief lesson · all levels.

Part A · Match each whakataukī to its meaning.

Nāku te rourou, nāu te rourou, ka ora ai te iwi.	My strength is not that of one person, but of many.
He aha te mea nui o te ao? He tangata, he tangata, he tangata.	The most important thing in the world is people.
Mā te huruhuru te manu ka rere.	When we all contribute, the people thrive.
Ehara taku toa i te toa takitahi, engari he toa takitini.	Support people so they can succeed.

Part B · Which whakataukī fits? Write its first few words.

1. A team wins because everyone plays their part. _____
2. A teacher gives a student the help they need to do well. _____
3. Someone sets a big goal and keeps going. _____

Part C · Rank the six whakataukī from 1 (best) to 6 for our class. Explain why your number 1 is the best choice.

Ara 1 · Find these words in the whakataukī and write the English.

1. manu _____
2. tangata _____
3. iwi _____
4. maunga _____

Ara 2 · Choose one whakataukī. Write it out, then write when you could use it at school or at home (English is fine).

Ara 3 · Explain one whakataukī in te reo, then give an example from your life. Ki tōku whakaaro, … nā te mea …

Everyone: design a poster for your favourite whakataukī (words and a picture).

Finished early? *Write your own saying using an image from nature (a bird, a tree, the sea) and explain it · Learn one whakataukī off by heart and say it to a partner · Write how a whakataukī could help in sport, music or friendships*

Ko au: all about me poster

We are learning to introduce ourselves in te reo Māori at our own level.

No te reo Māori needed. Time: **60 minutes**. Students know their level: Ara 1 = Novice 1, Ara 2 = Novice 2, Ara 3 = Novice 3. If a student is not sure, they start with Ara 1 and move on when they finish.

1. **Start:** (5 min) Greet the class. Slide 3: a student reads the Ara 1 example aloud.
2. **Learn:** (10 min) Slides 4–5: the Ara 2 and Ara 3 examples. Remind students pepeha is personal: kōrero tuakiri is fine.
3. **Do:** (35 min) Worksheet: interview a partner (Part A, 10 min), draft your introduction, then make the poster.
4. **Finish:** (10 min) Volunteers read their introduction aloud, or introduce their partner. Collect sheets.

Say it · pronunciation help

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Ka kite anō (kah KEE-teh ah-NAW): See you again

Print and devices

Print the worksheet. Coloured pencils for the poster. Not needed.

Answers

- Part A: answers vary (What is your name? How old are you? Where are you from? What is your favourite food? How are you?).
- Answers vary. Check: Ko … taku ingoa; … ōku tau; Nō … ahau; He pai ki ahau te …; rāua ko; toko- for people; Ko te … o … tōku rā whānau; Ko … te maunga; nā te mea; macrons.

At the end: collect the worksheets and leave them for the class teacher with a note of who was here.

Ingoa / Name:	Akomanga / Class:	Rā / Date:

Ko au: all about me

Relief lesson · all levels. Interview a partner, draft at your level, then make your poster.

Part A · Kōrero: interview a partner. Ask in te reo and write their answers.

Pātai (question)	Their answer
Ko wai tō ingoa?	
E hia ō tau?	
Nō hea koe?	
He aha tāu kai tino pai?	
Kei te pēhea koe?	

Ara 1 · Sentence starters

- *Kia ora koutou.*
- *Ko … taku ingoa.*
- *… ōku tau. (e.g. Tekau mā toru ōku tau.)*
- *Nō … ahau.*
- *He pai ki ahau te …*
- *Kei te … ahau. (e.g. Kei te pai ahau.)*

Ara 2 · Add

- *Ko … rāua ko … ōku mātua.*
- *Toko… mātou i tōku whānau.*
- *Ko te … o … tōku rā whānau.*

Ara 3 · Add (pepeha or kōrero tuakiri)

- *Ko … te maunga. Ko … te awa / moana.*
- *Ko … taku kura.*
- *He pai ki ahau te …, nā te mea …*
- *Ā tōna wā, ka … au. (One day, I will …)*

Draft · Write your introduction here.

Poster · Write your introduction neatly and add pictures.

Finished early? *Write three sentences introducing your partner: Ko … tōna ingoa. … ōna tau. Nō … ia. · Learn your introduction off by heart · Add labels in te reo to the pictures on your poster*

Te wharekai: café menu

We are learning food words, prices and how to order kai in te reo Māori.

No te reo Māori needed. Time: **60 minutes**. Students know their level: Ara 1 = Novice 1, Ara 2 = Novice 2, Ara 3 = Novice 3. If a student is not sure, they start with Ara 1 and move on when they finish.

1. **Start:** (5 min) Greet the class. Slide 3: read the kai words together.
2. **Learn:** (10 min) Slide 4: numbers and prices. Slide 5: read the ordering dialogue in pairs.
3. **Do:** (35 min) Worksheet: everyone designs a menu (Part A) and does the totals (Part B), then their Ara section.
4. **Finish:** (10 min) Café role-play: pairs take turns as kaimahi and kiritaki, ordering from each other's menus. Collect sheets.

Say it · pronunciation help

Kia ora koutou (kee-ah AW-rah koh-toh-oo): Hello everyone
Ka pai (kah pie): Good, well done
Ka kite anō (kah KEE-teh ah-NAW): See you again

Print and devices

Print the worksheet. Coloured pencils for menus. Not needed. Early finishers with devices can play Kōrero Mai (link on this page).

Answers

- Part B: $6 e ono tāra; $6 e ono tāra; $8 e waru tāra; tekau tāra ($10).
- Ara 1: prices with E + number + tāra (E rima tāra); 10 = tekau tāra.
- Ara 2: māu; (items from their menu); (price); Anei; tō.
- Ara 3: totals must match the menu; check i (past), He reka, Ki tōku whakaaro, nā te mea and macrons.

At the end: collect the worksheets and leave them for the class teacher with a note of who was here.

Ingoa / Name:	Akomanga / Class:	Rā / Date:

Te wharekai: café menu

Relief lesson · all levels.

Kupu / Word bank: parāoa · hēki · āporo · panana · keke · tiakarete · tī · kawhe · miraka · wai · ika · rīwai · kai = food · inu = drinks

Part A · Everyone: design your café menu. Give it a name, two sections (Kai, Inu) and a price for each item ($1–$10).

Part B · Everyone: work out the totals. Menu: parāoa $4 · hēki $3 · keke $5 · tī $2 · wai $1.

Order	Total ($)	Total in te reo
parāoa + tī		
keke + wai		
hēki + hēki + tī		
parāoa + keke + wai		

Ara 1 · Write five items from your menu with the price in te reo.

Kai / inu	English	Utu (te reo)

Ara 2 · Complete the ordering dialogue using your menu.

1. Kaimahi: Kia ora! He aha _____?
2. Kiritaki: He _me te _, ngā mihi.
3. Kaimahi: E _____ tāra.
4. Kiritaki: _____.
5. Kaimahi: Ngā mihi! Kia pai _____ rā.

Ara 3 · A customer orders three items from your menu. Write the order and the total in te reo (E hia katoa? … tāra). Then write a short review: I kai au i te … He reka! Ki tōku whakaaro, … nā te mea …

Finished early? *Make signs for your café: Kua tuwhera (Open) and Kua kati (Closed) · Design a logo and a te reo name for your café · Write a special of the day: Te kai motuhake o te rā: …*